

STATIC GK

Awards, Books, Organisations, Important Facts

For SSC | UPSC | Railway | Banking | State PSC | Defence Exams

1. IMPORTANT INTERNATIONAL ORGANISATIONS

Organisation	HQ	Head	Founded
UN	New York	Antonio Guterres	1945, 193 members
WHO	Geneva	Tedros Adhanom	1948
UNESCO	Paris	Audrey Azoulay	1945
UNICEF	New York	Catherine Russell	1946
IMF	Washington DC	K. Georgieva	1945, 190 members
World Bank	Washington DC	Ajay Banga	1944
WTO	Geneva	N. Okonjo-Iweala	1995, 164 members
NATO	Brussels	Mark Rutte	1949, 32 members
ASEAN	Jakarta	Kao Kim Hourn	1967, 10 members
SAARC	Kathmandu	Esala Weerakoon	1985, 8 members
BRICS	Rotating	India Chair 2026	2006, 10 members
SCO	Beijing	Zhang Ming	2001, 10 members

2. NATIONAL AWARDS OF INDIA

Civilian Awards (in order of precedence):

- > 1. Bharat Ratna: Highest civilian award. No limit on number. First recipients (1954): C. Rajagopalachari, S. Radhakrishnan, C.V. Raman.
- > 2. Padma Vibhushan: Exceptional and distinguished service.
- > 3. Padma Bhushan: Distinguished service of high order.
- > 4. Padma Shri: Distinguished service in any field.
- > Padma Awards announced on Republic Day eve (Jan 25) every year.

Sports Awards:

- > Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna: Highest sports honour (renamed from Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna).
- > Arjuna Award: Outstanding performance in sports for 4 consecutive years.
- > Dronacharya Award: Outstanding coaches.
- > Dhyan Chand Award: Lifetime contribution to sports development.

Literary Awards:

- > Jnanpith Award: Highest literary award in India. Given by Bharatiya Jnanpith Trust. For Indian languages listed in 8th Schedule.
- > Sahitya Akademi Award: Given by Sahitya Akademi for 24 languages.
- > Saraswati Samman: For outstanding literary work in Indian language (last 10 years).

Gallantry Awards:

- > Wartime: Param Vir Chakra (highest), Maha Vir Chakra, Vir Chakra.
- > Peacetime: Ashoka Chakra (highest), Kirti Chakra, Shaurya Chakra.

3. MAJOR INTERNATIONAL AWARDS

- > Nobel Prize: Physics, Chemistry, Medicine, Literature, Peace, Economics. Given in Stockholm (Peace in Oslo). Since 1901.
- > Indian Nobel Laureates: Rabindranath Tagore (Literature 1913), C.V. Raman (Physics 1930), Mother Teresa (Peace 1979), Amartya Sen (Economics 1998), Kailash Satyarthi (Peace 2014), Abhijit Banerjee (Economics 2019).
- > Pulitzer Prize: Journalism and literature (USA).
- > Booker Prize: Fiction writing in English language.
- > Oscar (Academy Award): Films. India's win: Bhanu Athaiya (1982, Gandhi), A.R. Rahman (2008, Slumdog Millionaire), Guneet Monga (2022, The Elephant Whisperers).
- > Grammy Award: Music achievement.
- > Fields Medal: Mathematics (given every 4 years). No Indian winner yet.
- > Abel Prize: Mathematics (annual, since 2003).
- > Magsaysay Award: 'Nobel Prize of Asia'. Given by Philippines.
- > Man Booker International Prize: For body of work in fiction (translated).

4. FIRST IN INDIA (Important Firsts)

- > First President: Dr. Rajendra Prasad (1950-62).
- > First PM: Jawaharlal Nehru (1947-64). First Woman PM: Indira Gandhi.
- > First CJI: H.J. Kania. First Woman CJI: None yet.
- > First Woman President: Pratibha Patil (2007-12).
- > First Field Marshal: Sam Manekshaw (1973).
- > First Indian in space: Rakesh Sharma (1984, Soyuz T-11).
- > First Indian woman in space: Kalpana Chawla (1997, US citizen).
- > First Indian citizen to ISS: Shubhanshu Shukla (2026, Axiom-4).
- > First Governor-General of free India: Lord Mountbatten. First Indian GG: C. Rajagopalachari.
- > First Indian ICS officer: Satyendranath Tagore.
- > First Indian to win Nobel: Rabindranath Tagore (1913).
- > First satellite: Aryabhata (1975). First launch vehicle: SLV-3 (1980).
- > First nuclear test: Smiling Buddha (Pokhran-I, 1974). Pokhran-II (1998).
- > First metro railway: Kolkata (1984). First bullet train project: Mumbai-Ahmedabad.
- > First paperless court: Kalpetta, Kerala (2026).

5. IMPORTANT BOUNDARIES & LINES

Line/Boundary	Between
Radcliffe Line	India and Pakistan (1947, drawn by Sir Cyril Radcliffe)
McMahon Line	India and China (drawn 1914, not accepted by China)
Durand Line	Pakistan and Afghanistan (1893)
Line of Control	India and Pakistan in Jammu & Kashmir
Line of Actual Control	India and China (de facto border)
17th Parallel	North and South Vietnam (historical)
38th Parallel	North and South Korea
49th Parallel	USA and Canada
Maginot Line	France and Germany
Hindenburg Line	Germany and Poland

6. IMPORTANT DAMS, RIVERS & PROJECTS

Dam/Project	River	State
Bhakra Nangal	Sutlej	Himachal Pradesh/Punjab
Tehri Dam	Bhagirathi	Uttarakhand (highest in India)
Hirakud Dam	Mahanadi	Odisha (longest in India)
Sardar Sarovar	Narmada	Gujarat
Nagarjuna Sagar	Krishna	Telangana/AP
Mettur Dam	Kaveri	Tamil Nadu
Tungabhadra Dam	Tungabhadra	Karnataka
Koyna Dam	Koyna	Maharashtra
Indira Sagar	Narmada	Madhya Pradesh (largest reservoir)
Farakka Barrage	Ganga	West Bengal

7. IMPORTANT FOLK DANCES OF INDIA

State	Folk Dances
Punjab	Bhangra, Giddha
Rajasthan	Ghoomar, Kalbelia, Chari
Gujarat	Garba, Dandiya Raas
Maharashtra	Lavani, Tamasha
Assam	Bihu, Bhortal
West Bengal	Chhau, Jatra
Kerala	Kathakali, Mohiniyattam, Thiruvathira
Tamil Nadu	Bharatanatyam, Kummi, Kolattam
Karnataka	Yakshagana, Dollu Kunitha
Andhra Pradesh	Kuchipudi, Lambadi
Manipur	Manipuri (Ras Leela)
Jharkhand	Chhau (Seraikella)
Uttarakhand	Garhwali, Langvir Nritya
J&K	Rouf, Dumhal
Mizoram	Cheraw (Bamboo Dance)

8. CLASSICAL DANCES OF INDIA (8 Forms)

Dance	State	Key Feature
Bharatanatyam	Tamil Nadu	Oldest classical dance. Temple dance.
Kathak	Uttar Pradesh	Storytelling through dance. Mughal influence.
Kathakali	Kerala	Elaborate costumes/makeup. Stories from epics.
Kuchipudi	Andhra Pradesh	Dance-drama tradition. Brass plate dance.
Odissi	Odisha	Temple sculpture inspired. Tribhangi posture.
Manipuri	Manipur	Devotional themes. Ras Leela.
Mohiniyattam	Kerala	Feminine, graceful. 'Dance of enchantress'.
Sattriya	Assam	Vaishnava monasteries. Added by SNA in 2000.

9. NATIONAL SYMBOLS OF INDIA

- > National Flag: Tricolour (Saffron, White, Green + Ashoka Chakra). Designed by Pingali Venkayiah. Adopted July 22, 1947.
- > National Emblem: Lion Capital of Ashoka (Sarnath). Adopted January 26, 1950. Motto: Satyameva Jayate.
- > National Anthem: Jana Gana Mana (Rabindranath Tagore). Adopted Jan 24, 1950. Duration: 52 seconds.
- > National Song: Vande Mataram (Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay, from Anandamath).
- > National Animal: Royal Bengal Tiger. National Bird: Indian Peacock.
- > National Flower: Lotus. National Tree: Banyan (Indian Fig).
- > National Fruit: Mango. National River: Ganga.
- > National Aquatic Animal: Gangetic Dolphin. National Heritage Animal: Indian Elephant.
- > National Game: Hockey (unofficial). National Currency: Indian Rupee (INR).
- > National Calendar: Saka Calendar (Chaitra 1 = March 22). Adopted 1957.

10. IMPORTANT RIVERS - ORIGIN & MOUTH

River	Origin	Mouth/Meets	Length(km)
Ganga	Gangotri Glacier, UK	Bay of Bengal	2,525
Yamuna	Yamunotri Glacier, UK	Ganga at Prayagraj	1,376
Brahmaputra	Angsi Glacier, Tibet	Bay of Bengal	2,900
Godavari	Trimbakeshwar, Nashik	Bay of Bengal	1,465
Krishna	Mahabaleshwar, MH	Bay of Bengal	1,400
Kaveri	Talakaveri, Karnataka	Bay of Bengal	805
Narmada	Amarkantak, MP	Arabian Sea	1,312
Tapti	Multai, MP	Arabian Sea	724
Indus	Mansarovar, Tibet	Arabian Sea	2,880
Mahanadi	Sihawa, CG	Bay of Bengal	858